

The Prevention Case

An ADSB campaign package: getting disability income onto the FCSSAA floor

The Alberta Disability System Breakdown · St. Albert, Alberta · 2026 *Original ADSB material. Free to read, print, adapt, and submit.*

The deadline is real: noon, Saturday, September 26, 2026.

Resolutions go to **director@fcssaa.org**. The vote is at the FCSSAA Annual General Meeting on **November 25, 2026**. After September 26, we wait a full year.

What this is

Once a year, the Family and Community Support Services Association of Alberta — FCSSAA, the body that ties together nearly 200 member FCSS programs across Alberta — votes on **resolutions**: formal asks that the whole association then carries to the Government of Alberta. Past resolutions have advocated for a provincial poverty-reduction strategy (2014) and an affordable-housing plan for Albertans (2016). They pass, and they become the association's marching orders.

We want one on disability income this year. This package is everything you need to make that happen in your town: the argument, the resolution itself, two ready-to-send emails, and the people to send them to.

This package is built from our own campaign's evidence and the government's published numbers. We don't put our name on borrowed work — so every part of it is ours to stand behind.

Why FCSS is the right room

The whole case fits in one line: **prevention is cheaper than collapse, and**

disability income is prevention.

That is not our slogan — it is the founding logic of FCSS. Family and Community Support Services exist to catch a problem upstream, before it becomes a crisis a community has to absorb. When disability income is lowered, when a couple's rate is cut, when a federal benefit is reduced by a provincial offset, the need does not disappear. It relocates — to the food bank, the housing line, the crisis phone, and the FCSS-funded supports built to prevent those very things. That makes disability income a prevention question, and a fair one to put to FCSSAA.

A second example is already in motion, in the same households, at the same time. Alberta has changed how rent is set in subsidized and community housing to a flat 30 per cent of a household's total income, and it is steadily removing the income that used to be left out of that calculation. A \$1,200-a-year exemption for households with dependent children is already being removed as tenants reach their annual review; beginning January 1, 2027 the Canada Child Benefit and the Alberta Child and Family Benefit will be counted as income for the Rent Assistance Benefit, followed by all community-housing households on January 1, 2028 (Social Housing Accommodation Regulation, AR 244/1994, as amended by AR 122/2025). The effect is that families with children — including many disabled parents and parents of disabled children — pay more rent and are left with less for food, utilities, and everyday costs. That shortfall does not vanish; it lands on food banks, utility assistance, and the same FCSS-funded supports meant to prevent those crises. It is the same pattern as the disability-income changes, reaching the same families from a second direction.

The one rule that shapes everything

Only FCSS member programs and municipal or Métis Settlement councils can submit a resolution. Not individuals. Not campaigns. Not advocacy organizations, however large. That rule is the same for everyone outside the FCSS system.

So the only way this reaches the floor is if **a councillor or an FCSS board sponsors it** — and the only way that happens is if they hear from us. That is the whole play: we are the megaphone, your council is the hand that files the paper. One sponsor is all it takes.

How to act — about 15 minutes

1. **Start with your own municipality.** Search “[your town] council contact” and “[your town] FCSS.” Your own town’s voice carries the most weight.
2. **Send the email below** — paste it, add your name, send. Ask them to sponsor the resolution and submit it before September 26.
3. **Then write the warm list.** The towns further down already spoke up about the disability-income changes. They are the most likely yes.

Send to a councillor, an FCSS board representative, and the FCSS program staff where you can. More doors, better odds.

Email 1 — to a municipal councillor

Subject: Please sponsor an FCSSAA resolution on disability income — due September 26

Dear Councillor [name],

I’m a resident of [municipality]. I’m writing to ask you to sponsor a resolution at this year’s FCSSAA Annual General Meeting. Resolutions are due to FCSSAA by noon on September 26, 2026, at director@fcssaa.org.

Recent changes to Alberta’s disability income are pushing more disabled Albertans toward poverty. When income falls, the need doesn’t vanish — it lands on food banks, housing programs, and the FCSS-funded supports meant to prevent those crises in the first place.

FCSS exists to strengthen people and communities through prevention, which makes this a fair and fitting thing for FCSSAA to carry. The proposed resolution is below. I would be grateful if you would bring it forward through your council or local FCSS board before the September 26 deadline.

Thank you for your time, and for standing up for our community.

[Your name] · [Your town] · [Phone or email, if you wish]

Email 2 — to FCSS staff, an advisory committee member, or a provincial board member

Subject: Support for a proposed FCSSAA resolution on disability income and prevention

Dear [name],

As someone involved in Family and Community Support Services, you see the link between income security and the demand placed on local preventive services every day. I'm writing to ask you to support — and where you can, help bring forward — a resolution for this year's FCSSAA AGM. Resolutions are due by noon on September 26, 2026, at director@fcssaa.org.

The proposed resolution asks FCSSAA to advocate that disability income assistance meet basic needs as measured by the Market Basket Measure plus the added costs of living with a disability, preserve the full value of the federal Canada Disability Benefit, maintain access to health and disability-related benefits, and be designed so it prevents rather than shifts hardship onto municipal and community services.

This is squarely within the preventive, community-building purpose of FCSS. I would be grateful if you would discuss it with your local FCSS board, advisory committee, or regional representative.

Thank you for your ongoing commitment to stronger, more inclusive communities.

[Your name] · [Phone or email]

THE RESOLUTION

Topic: Disability Income as Prevention — Protecting Community Wellbeing Through Adequate Disability Income Support

BE IT RESOLVED THAT the Family and Community Support Services Association of Alberta call on the Government of Alberta to ensure that disability income assistance — under both the Assured Income for the Severely Handicapped (AISH) and the Alberta Disability Assistance Program (ADAP) — provides income that meets or exceeds the Market Basket Measure (Canada’s official poverty line) together with the additional costs of living with a disability; preserves the full value of the federal Canada Disability Benefit without an offsetting reduction in provincial benefits; maintains access to health and disability-related benefits regardless of a person’s employment income; and is designed so that it prevents, rather than shifts, avoidable hardship onto municipal and community-based preventive services.

RATIONALE

Family and Community Support Services exist to strengthen individuals, families, and communities through prevention. When people fall into poverty, housing instability, food insecurity, or isolation, the demand lands on community-based and FCSS-funded services. Adequate, stable disability income is one of the most direct preventive supports available, because it keeps people out of the crises those services are built to address.

People with disabilities carry costs other Albertans do not: disability-related transportation, assistive technology, medical supplies, specialized supports, and accessibility. Income support should therefore be measured against the Market Basket Measure *plus* those additional costs. As of the 2026 benefit period, the Government of Alberta reports a core ADAP financial benefit of \$1,740 per month; beginning in the August 2026 benefit period, two adults in the same household who each receive disability income assistance each receive 88 per cent of the maximum individual benefit. Where disability income sits below the Market Basket Measure, or where the value of a federal disability benefit is reduced by a provincial offset, the predictable result is greater poverty, greater instability, and greater reliance on municipal and community services.

The government’s published figures also show a trade-off in work incentives. An AISH

recipient may keep only the first \$350 of monthly employment income before deductions begin, compared with \$700 under ADAP — and \$1,100 for an ADAP recipient with dependent children, or \$1,500 for a cohabiting partner under either program. A low earnings exemption limits how much a person can lift their own income through work, which runs against both employment participation and the prevention of poverty.

A 2025 lived-experience policy brief on the Canada Disability Benefit, led by Brittany Finlay through the University of Calgary's Disability Policy Research Program, urges the Government of Alberta to reverse its treatment of the Canada Disability Benefit as non-exempt income (the clawback) so that recipients receive the additional federal support. A 2026 University of Calgary School of Public Policy briefing paper, *Reforming Disability Income Support in Alberta for Employment and Equity* (Jardine, Fyie and Zwicker), further finds that pairing adequate income security with higher earnings exemptions and meaningful employment supports is a more effective, evidence-based approach to advancing both income security and employment participation than reducing benefit levels and earnings exemptions. Together, these measures would protect income at the household level and reduce downstream demand on community supports.

When people with disabilities have income that meets their needs, stable supports, and a real path to participate in work and community life, they are far less likely to reach the point of crisis. Protecting disability income is therefore not outside the FCSS mandate — it is the clearest expression of it.

Note for the sponsoring council or FCSS board

This resolution is written to meet FCSSAA's three tests: it addresses one clear concern (adequacy and protection of disability income), it has a direct impact on demand placed on FCSS-funded and community-based services, and it fits the FCSS prevention mandate. It follows the required *BE IT RESOLVED / RATIONALE* format. Please keep it neutral and constructive on submission — it is written as a policy ask, not as criticism of any government or party, and the neutral version is the one that carries.

Who to contact

Warm list — towns that already spoke up on the disability-income changes

Start here. These councils have already passed pause motions or written to the Minister, so they understand the issue.

- **Barrhead** — Cllr Steven Fylyshtan sfylyshtan@barrhead.ca · Cllr Anthony Oswald aoswald@barrhead.ca · FCSS staff reception@barrheadfcss.org
- **Calgary** — Cllr Nathaniel Schmidt (also FCSSAA board) ward8@calgary.ca · Mayor Jeromy Farkas mayor@calgary.ca · staff CommunityWellbeingPartners@calgary.ca
- **Camrose** — Cllr Agnes Hoveland ahoveland@camrose.ca · Cllr Joy-Anne Murphy jmurphy@camrose.ca · Director Lyndel Kasa director@camrosefcss.ca
- **Claresholm** — Director Barbara Bell fcss.director@claresholm.ca · Cllr David Knox david.knox@claresholm.ca · Cllr Kandice Meister kandice.meister@claresholm.ca · Cllr Seth Wagner seth.wagner@claresholm.ca
- **Cold Lake** — Director Kim Schmidt kschmidt@coldlake.com · Cllr Raymond Cowell rcowell@coldlake.com
- **Cochrane** — Theresa Bolton (FCSSAA board) fcss@cochrane.ca · Manager Kim Krawec kim.krawec@cochrane.ca · Cllr Marni Singh marni.singh@cochrane.ca
- **Edmonton** — Judy Smith judy.smith@edmonton.ca · Cllr Jo-Anne Wright jo-anne.wright@edmonton.ca · Cllr Keren Tang keren.tang@edmonton.ca
- **Grande Prairie** — Cllr Brian Peterson (FCSSAA board) · Director Melodie McCracken fcss@countygpr.ab.ca · Mayor Jackie Clayton jclayton@cityofgp.com
- **Lethbridge** — Danielle Lenaour danielle.lenaour@lethbridge.ca · Cllr Belinda Crowson belinda.crowson@lethbridge.ca · Mayor Blaine Hyggen mayor@lethbridge.ca · Cllr Jenn Schmidt-Rempel jenn.schmidt-rempe@lethbridge.ca
- **Medicine Hat** — FCSS Director Shona Dickie shodic@medicinehat.ca · 403-502-8718
- **Red Deer** — Manager Bobby-Jo Stannard culturemailbox@reddeer.ca · Cllr Cassandra Curtis cassandra.curtis@reddeer.ca · Cllr Jaelene Tweedle jaelene.tweedle@reddeer.ca
- **Rocky Mountain House** — Mayor Shane Boniface sboniface@trmh.ca · Manager Andrea Hardy fcssmanager@trmh.ca

- **St. Albert** — Manager Connie Smigielski csmigielski@stalbert.ca · Cllr Shelley Biermansi sbiermansi@stalbert.ca · Cllr Amanda Patrick apatrick@stalbert.ca

FCSSAA provincial board — worth a note as well

President Kayla Blanchette (Bonnyville) bdfcss@town.bonnyville.ab.ca · Nathaniel Schmidt (Calgary) ward8@calgary.ca · George Glazier (Paintearth County) gglazier@countypaintearth.ca · Philip Penrod (Beaumont) keep.reaching.beaumont@gmail.com · Darlene Reimer (Athabasca County) info@athabascacounty.com · Kathleen Waxer (Jasper) kwaxer@jasper-alberta.ca · Tara Gilchrist (Canmore) tara.gilchrist@canmore.ca · Zakk Morrison (Barons-Eureka-Warner) zakk.morrison@fcss.ca · Tracy Proulx (Westlock) tproulx@westlock.ca · Crystal Tremblay (Smoky River, Secretary) srfcss@live.ca

Sourcing — so every figure holds up

- **ADAP core benefit (\$1,740/month), the 88% couple rate (from the August 2026 benefit period), and the published earnings exemptions** (\$350 AISH; \$700 ADAP; \$1,100 ADAP parent; \$1,500 cohabiting partner): Government of Alberta, Alberta Disability Assistance Program page, alberta.ca — verified August 2026.
- **The Canada Disability Benefit clawback:** “Losing the Canada Disability Benefit means losing hope for many Albertans,” lived-experience brief led by Brittany Finlay, University of Calgary Disability Policy Research Program, July 2025 — dipo.ca/updates/aish-cdb-brief.
- **Income security paired with employment supports and higher earnings exemptions:** MacKenna Jardine, Ken Fyie and Jennifer Zwicker, *Reforming Disability Income Support in Alberta for Employment and Equity*, University of Calgary School of Public Policy, Briefing Paper Vol. 19:07, June 2026 — policyschool.ca (HSP140).
- **Subsidized-housing rent changes (30% of total income; child-benefit and dependent-child exemptions removed; Jan 1 2027 for the Rent Assistance Benefit and Jan 1 2028 for community housing):** Social

Housing Accommodation Regulation, AR 244/1994, as amended by AR 122/2025, with exemptions set by Ministerial Order; implementation confirmed by housing management bodies — Civida, civida.ca/shar.

- **Market Basket Measure:** Statistics Canada's official poverty line; the resolution asks that income be measured against it plus disability-related costs, stated as the standard rather than a fixed dollar figure.
- **The prevention-and-demand logic:** ADSB campaign documentation (Payment Instability, Access Barrier, Alberta Housing Crisis, and Human Cost findings).
- **Nearly 200 member FCSS programs, and the past resolutions on a provincial poverty-reduction strategy (2014) and an affordable-housing plan for Albertans (2016):** FCSSAA home page and Resolutions page, fcssaa.org — verified August 2026.

What is not in here, on purpose: no member names, no unverified dollar claims presented as settled, and nothing that reads as a partisan attack. That is what keeps it ours *and* keeps it eligible.

Ask in writing. Keep the answer. And this time, ask them to carry it for us.

****Chantal @@ROSE@@*** The Alberta Disability System Breakdown — St. Albert, Alberta albertadisabilitybreakdown@outlook.com*